



STICKY WICKET: Karunanidhi on his one-day fast trade unions allegedly stopped even the plying of buses while the authorities looked away. When this was brought to the notice of the apex court, it threatened the dismissal of the DMK Government on grounds of "constitutional breakdown".

Karunanidhi had to end his fast mid-way and meet senior government officials at the secretariat. Some buses were made to ply and efforts made to create a semblance of normalcy but shops and offices remained shut partly because of lack of time and partly because of fear of violence.

The chief minister also clarified that there was no "constitutional breakdown" in the state. AIADMK, meanwhile, has declared it would file a contempt petition against the state Government. Karunanidhi has often in the past criticised arch-rival, AIADMK supremo J. Jayalalithaa, for having "scant regard for the judiciary and its judgements". The heat is clearly on him this time.

by S. Senthil Kumar

SIGNPOSTS

TOOK OVER: General Deepak Kapoor, as the new army chief. He has served as vice-chief of the army and as northern army commander. He takes over from General J.J. Singh.



WON: By Pankaj Advani, the IBSF World billiards title in Singapore. He retained the title after beating teammate Dhruv Sitwala.

PRESENTED: To Dr M.S. Swaminathan, the Lal Bahadur Shastri National Award for excellence in public administration, academics and management and for his contribution to agriculture, by President Pratibha Patil.

WON: By young tribal boys of Orissa, the Under-14 World Rugby Cup in England on September 29. The students of the Kalinga Institute of Social Sciences defeated South Africa 19-5. The institute is home to 5,000 tribal children.

The Fast and the Fury

CHENNAI With the Supreme Court having banned "bandhs", the DMK-led Government's call for a bandh on October 1 for the early implementation of the Sethusamudram project was challenged in the Madras High Court by the Opposition AIADMK. Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi, however, assured the high court that the strike would be peaceful, upon which it was granted the go-ahead. AIADMK challenged the high court decision in the apex court. Hearing

the state government's resolve to go ahead with the bandh, Justice B.N. Aggarwal and P.P. Naolekar on September 30 warned it against going ahead with the bandh on October 1 or on any other day. It held that political parties had no right to enforce a bandh which interfered with the freedom of citizens.

Karunanidhi then decided to sit on a fast instead, declaring that this did not mean going against the apex court's order. On the fateful day,

VIS-A-VIS J. JAYALALITHAA AIADMK supremo **versus** PRIYA RANJAN DASMUNSHI Information & Broadcasting minister

Karunanidhi's decision to go on a fast has become a laughing matter. It shows that DMK has lost its clout at the Centre.



Karunanidhi is following Gandhi's principles. There's nothing wrong in going on a fast. DMK is an important ally of the Congress.

EPILOGUE: With religious sentiments of people involved, no fast can put this project on a fast track.